

Grammar

Past Simple

We use the past simple for finished actions or situations at a definite time in the past. Regular verbs add -ed; many common verbs are irregular.

Geçmişte belirli bir zamanda tamamlanmış eylemler veya durumlar için past simple kullanılır. Düzenli fiillere -ed eklenir; birçok yaygın fiil ise düzensizdir.

When? Use it for a single finished action, a series of finished actions, or a past state that is now over.

Tek bir tamamlanmış eylem, art arda gelen tamamlanmış eylemler veya artık bitmiş bir geçmiş durum için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + V2 (regular: verb + -ed)
- She worked hard.
- They moved to a new city.

Negative

- Subject + didn't + base verb
- She didn't give up.
- They didn't have much money.

Question

- Did + subject + base verb...?
- Did she work hard?
- Did they move to a new city?

Short answers

- Yes, she did. / No, she didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She not worked hard.~~ → **She didn't work hard.**
- ~~Did she moved to the city?~~ → **Did she move to the city?**
- ~~He goed to school every day.~~ → **He went to school every day.**

1. When she was a child, her family _____ (not have) a car.

2. Which sentence is correct?

- a. She study every night.
- b. She studied every night.
- c. She studying every night.
- d. She studies every night ago.

3. _____ they move to a bigger house last year? (question)

4. He didn't gave up on his dream. — True / False

5. Put the words in order: hard / worked / two / jobs / she

6. Rewrite in the negative: They had enough money.

7. Choose the correct irregular past form of 'lose'.

- a. losed
- b. lost
- c. loses
- d. losing

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8. Despite the hardship, the family _____ (survive) together.

9. Turn into a question: She finished school at 18.

10. Put the words in order: overcome / the / difficult / he / years / most

Past Continuous (and Past Continuous with 'while')

We use the past continuous (was/were + verb-ing) for an action in progress at a specific moment in the past, or for two actions happening at the same time, often linked with 'while'.

Past continuous (was/were + fiil-ing), geçmişte belirli bir anda devam eden bir eylem için veya genellikle 'while' ile bağlanan, aynı anda gerçekleşen iki eylem için kullanılır.

When? Use it for background actions in progress, actions interrupted by another action (with past simple), or two parallel actions with 'while'.

Devam etmekte olan arka plan eylemleri, başka bir eylem tarafından kesilen eylemler (past simple ile birlikte) veya 'while' ile ifade edilen iki paralel eylem için kullanılır.

Positive

- Subject + was/were + verb-ing
- She was studying at night.
- They were working long hours.

Negative

- Subject + wasn't/weren't + verb-ing
- He wasn't earning much.
- They weren't sleeping well.

Question

- Was/Were + subject + verb-ing...?
- Was she studying?
- Were they working long hours?

Short answers

- Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't.
- Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.

Common mistakes

- ~~She was study when the phone rang.~~ → **She was studying when the phone rang.**
- ~~While she was studying, her mother cooked.~~ → **While she was studying, her mother was cooking.**
- ~~They was working hard.~~ → **They were working hard.**

1. At 9 p.m. last night, she _____ (write) her homework.

2. While his parents were working, he _____ his younger brothers.

- a. look after
- b. was looking after
- c. looked after
- d. looking after

3. _____ you _____ (sleep) when the storm started?

4. They were not sleeping well during that period. — *True / False*

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5. Put the words in order: was / while / studying / she / working / her / brother / was

6. Combine using 'while': He was cooking. His sister was cleaning.

7. While the family _____ (struggle) financially, neighbours _____ (bring) them food.

8. Put the words in order: doing / were / arrived / letter / what / the / when / you

Used to

We use 'used to' + base verb to talk about repeated past habits or past states that are no longer true.

'Used to' + fiilin yalın hali, artık doğru olmayan tekrarlanan geçmiş alışkanlıkları veya geçmiş durumları anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? Use it to contrast a past habit/state with the present situation. Do not use it for a single, one-time action.

Geçmişteki bir alışkanlığı/durumu şimdiki durumla karşılaştırmak için kullanılır. Tek seferlik bir eylem için kullanılmaz.

Positive

- Subject + used to + base verb
- He used to walk to school.
- They used to live in a village.

Negative

- Subject + didn't use to + base verb
- She didn't use to eat meat.
- We didn't use to have a car.

Question

- Did + subject + use to + base verb...?
- Did he use to walk to school?
- Did they use to live in a village?

Short answers

- Yes, he did. / No, he didn't.
- Yes, they did. / No, they didn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~He use to walk to school.~~ → **He used to walk to school.**
- ~~She didn't used to eat meat.~~ → **She didn't use to eat meat.**
- ~~I used to go to the cinema yesterday.~~ → **I went to the cinema yesterday.**

1. They _____ (live) in a small village before they moved to the city.

2. Which is correct?

- a. She didn't used to smile much.
- b. She didn't use to smile much.
- c. She not used to smile much.
- d. She use to not smile much.

3. _____ you _____ (play) outside all day when you were a child?

4. He use to work in a shoe factory. — *True / False*

5. Rewrite using 'used to': In the past, she had very little money.

6. Put the words in order: school / walk / to / used / he / to

7. We _____ (not have) enough food during the hardest years, but things are better now.

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8. Explain the difference: 'I used to go to that school' vs 'I went to that school yesterday'.